

Hackathon @ Berkeley Prizes

Track Name	Track Criteria	Prize(s)
Grand Prize: Ddoski's World	Best project in the track, selected after finalist presentations.	\$5K cash prize
Grand Prize: Ddoski's Toolbox	Best project in the track, selected after finalist presentations.	\$5K cash prize
Grand Prize: Ddoski's Lab	Best project in the track, selected after finalist presentations.	\$5K cash prize
Grand Prize: Ddoski's Playground	Best project in the track, selected after finalist presentations.	\$5K cash prize
Finalists (top 10 teams)	For all finalists invited to present on-stage at the Closing Ceremony.	Limited edition AI Hackathon 2026 merch
SkyDeck Grand Prize Winner	One startup-oriented Grand Prize winner will be invited to join SkyDeck's incubator program!	Guaranteed admission to SkyDeck's Pad-13 incubator program
Best UI/UX	Unique and Innovative UI/UX designs	Kodak Chemera Cameras

Best Solo Hack	Highly Received Solo Hack	XGIMI Projector
Most Technical Hack	Most technically advanced.	Flashforge 3D Printers
Best Golden Bear Hack	For the best project that addresses a challenge faced by Berkeley students.	\$100 Cal Student Store gift cards
Best Beginner Hack	To be eligible, all members of your team must have attended 0 prior hackathons.	AirPods 4 Noise Cancellation
Hacker's Choice	Voted on by hackers during judging!	Mechanical Keyboards
Most Questionable Use of 24 Hours	Anything but hacking...	Lego Sets

Sponsor Tracks

Many of our sponsors are offering prize tracks for the best & most creative uses of their tools. These are summarized below. More information, including the Hacker Starter Pack for each track that you will need to get started, will be posted on our Live Site at the start of the hackathon. Note that these prizes are subject to change.

We highly encourage you to participate in at least one sponsor track! Our sponsors bring immense value and state-of-the-art technologies to your hackathon experience that will be at your fingertips this weekend. Furthermore, sponsors very frequently recruit straight from students they meet at hackathons!

Sponsor	Track Criteria	Prize(s)
Annapurna Labs	Coming soon!	Coming soon!

(Co-Host)		
Fetch AI (Co-Host)	Coming soon!	Cash (\$1500, \$1000, \$500)
Midjourney	Coming soon!	Coming soon!
Interaction Co	Technical depth of the integration, usefulness of the automation, and overall hack originality.	Coming soon!
The Token Company	Depth of research, ingenuity, creativity.	Claude Code, Money, Merch
Redis	- Using Redis Beyond Caching: leveraging our AI tools like Redis Iris for Agent memory, vector search, context retrieval - Creativity and originality: solving real human problems in ways we haven't seen before, has a fun factor - Technical Implementation: Quality and sophistication of the engineering, Correctness, scalability, and architecture.	Mac Minis, 25k Redis Cloud credits for the team, Redis Timbuk2 backpacks
Anthropic	Our tech prize this year celebrates teams that reach the furthest: projects built with Claude Code that tackle meaningful issues in health, education, economic opportunity, or any domain where AI could genuinely shift what's possible for people. We know you have limited time, but aspiration and effort matter more than the outcome this time, so take the biggest swing toward the most challenging problem you can think of!	\$5000 in API credits (total), an office hour with our Applied AI team, and an invitation to visit our office in SF.
Browserbase	Participants are tasked with building any agent that uses the web - any framework, harness, model - but it must be powered by the Browserbase platform. Must use one of the following: browsers, search, fetch, Stagehand, Browse CLI.	Coming soon!
Orkes	1. How did they use Agentspan to build an agent or bring an agent 2. How well did they integrate Agentspan into their demos	Ray Ban Metas
Simular	Projects must use a Simular product (Sai, SimuLang, or Agent S) in a meaningful way and post about the experience on X or LinkedIn, tagging @official accounts. Judges will pick the winning team based on creativity (bonus points for novel use cases), technical execution, and real-world impact. (Optional if the organizer has other submission channel - to be considered, email zening@simular.ai with your team name, project description, social post link, and a	Prize package worth \$500

	short note on how you used Simular product).	
PaleBlueDot AI	Coming soon!	Coming soon!
QNX	Hard requirements: - Product uses QNX OS -Product includes one of the open-source AI modules available at https://oss.qnx.com Judging criteria: - Is it a "cannot-fail" embedded application? - Does it require real-time or reliability? - Is it using AI in an interesting or creative way? - Is it running on the embedded hardware (and not in cloud)?	\$1000 main winner, 2 x \$250 runner-up prizes
Arize	Evidence that Arize was used and actually improved the application.	\$1k cash (delivered as gift cards)
Overshoot AI	Coming soon!	Coming soon!
Fieldguide	Coming soon!	Coming soon!
Deepgram	The Deepgram prize goes to the team that builds the most creative and well-executed voice-powered experience using Deepgram's APIs. We'll judge on creativity of the voice interaction, technical execution, and how essential voice is to the experience (rather than tacked on). Submitted projects must demonstrably use at least one Deepgram product (speech-to-text, text-to-speech, or the voice agent API).	Nintendo Switch 2 for each member of the team
Sentry	Sentry is looking for builders who go beyond the prompt, we want to see strong technical execution paired with clear communication, collaborative problem-solving, and the confidence to speak up, course-correct, and lead when it counts. The best submissions will demonstrate not just what you built, but how your team worked together under pressure to make it happen. Bonus points if you leveraged observability or error monitoring in your project(s), we love engineers who think about reliability from day one.	Nintendo Switch 2 System for each member of the team
Pika	- Creativity and originality - Effective use of Pika MCP and AI workflows - Quality and impact of the final output	First: 500 + office visit + Pika MCP credit 10k + Merch; Second: 300 + office visit + Pika MCP credit 10k Third: 200+ office visit + Pika MCP credit 5k

Cognition	Most interesting & technically impressive project built with Devin.	Devin credits + TBD
Band	We would like to provide the prize to the top project overall that used Band as a key technology in their project. So we rely on the regular judging for ranking projects, just pick the top one that used Band in a significant way (at least 2 agents collaborating via the BAND platform).	\$1000 overall in amazon gift cards, split equally to winners. Prize to be distributed post hackathon.
Ultimate Bots	\$3,000 Best Physical AI Hack — one prize, one winner. Open to any team, stack, or direction, as long as it's physical AI: code that closes the loop with a real or simulated robot, or generates, curates, or evaluates the data and worlds that train one. Submissions via Devpost on Sunday (≤ 3 -min demo video, public repo or doc, 200-word writeup); the judges' test: would a real robotics team use it?	\$3,000 cash prize, plus top 4 Ghost Trials performers invited to perform on stage at our June 26 SF show.
Cognichip	Projects will be evaluated on their creative and technically sound use of the Cognichip Artificial Chip Intelligence™ platform to solve a real chip design problem. Judges will assess design methodology and execution, quality of the final deliverable, and how effectively the team leveraged AI to accelerate the design process.	Tiny tapeout credits
Terac	Build a simple annotation app, use Terac to collect real human-labeled data from our panel, then fine-tune a model on that data and show it beats the base model. To be eligible, your training data must come from annotations collected through Terac during the event, not synthetic or pre-existing datasets. Projects are judged on improvement over the base model shown to hold on unseen examples (50%), the creativity and UX of your annotation environment (30%), and how smartly you used the human data within your \$250 credit (20%).	1000\$ (1st place), 400\$ (2nd place)